

■ Budget

Tech for cheap!

Budget 2023 was announced by the Union Minister of Finance, Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman. So, you may be wondering what's cheaper, and what's costlier. Well, 3 technology products that could be cheaper going forward are mobile phones, TV, and EVs.

Here's what you need to know about Budget 2023 from a technology standpoint:

Cheaper tech products after budget 2023

1. Mobile Phones

The government has announced cuts in customs duty on the import of certain items used in mobile phone manufacturing. Meanwhile, the previous relaxations in customs duty on the camera lens and parts of the camera module used in modern phones are being carried on for one more year.

2. Televisions

In the custom duty rate changes (Section C.1 of the



Indian Budget 2023-2024), there is mention of a 2.5-per cent reduction in basic customs duty on parts of open cells of TV panels.

3. EVs

This budget also keeps the customs duty on "specified capital goods/machinery for manufacture of lithium-ion cells" that is used within electric cars and other electric vehicles.

In her speech, Smt. Sitharaman also attributed the Phased Manufacturing programme and other government initiatives to the growth in mobile phone production in India from 5.8 crore units (~18,900 crores in value) in 2014-15 to 31 crore units (more than 2,75,000 crores in value) in 2022-23. She envisions the new tax cuts in Budget 2023 could act as a tailwind for the respective product categories and sectors."

■ OTT

Disney+ Hotstar Profiles launched



Disney takes a leaf out of Netflix and Amazon Prime Video's book and finally launches Profiles on Disney+ Hotstar. The Hotstar profiles feature lets you create "personalized spaces for friends and family". You get to set up 7 Disney Plus Hotstar profiles. Here, we will see how you can make profiles on Hotstar and also learn how to use it.

How to set up Disney+ Hotstar Profiles

1. Download and log in to the Disney+ Hotstar app, if you haven't already.
2. On the Disney+ Hotstar homepage, you will see the new Profiles section. We got the profiles feature banner on the Disney+ Hotstar Android app.
3. Click on the Edit option.

4. At present, the subsequent screen shows "Coming Soon!" Clicking it, the message reads, "More Profiles are Coming Soon. You will be able to create personalized spaces for friends and family".

However, when the feature is fully available, you will be able to create a profile with a profile name, a profile picture or an Avatar.

5. Now, you can let the app know your content preferences.
6. Hit Save and that's it.

There's one thing that you should know about Disney+ Hotstar Profile. You cannot delete the original profile of the account holder. But, the option to create up to seven profiles should be plenty good for most of you all. **■**